which had just been occupied by the Germans. From my parents' letters I can follow the hours, days, and weeks they went and queued at the Préfecture de Police to get an authorization to stay in Paris, then the months they each spent learning a trade to earn a living (while I was in a children's home). My mother became a beautician, which was useful for two more years, while we lived in central France, having escaped, once more, from a Paris occupied by the Germans. My father, who was an insurance company lawyer in Prague, learned to make cheese in the hope of obtaining a visa for Canada, which he never got; he ultimately gave German lessons. What did they both hope for and never receive? A visa (immigration certificate) for Palestine, where, as my father wrote in one of his letters, one feels like a free person, notwithstanding all the difficulties. They never reached Palestine. They were murdered in Auschwitz. This was the antisemitism that was. Palestine as a hope, and Israel as a reality, are the justification for the existence of a Jewish state on the land of Israel. For me, it is the only valid and fully convincing one, on condition that we show justice to the people we dispossessed and share the land with them. Otherwise, in one form or another, there will always be some kind of opposition, some kind of resistance to our presence. Let's not fool ourselves.

Under US pressure, the Israeli cabinet agreed to allow more fuel to be delivered to the enclave. It seems that the president and an important part of the administration are getting impatient with what they consider as insufficient Israeli efforts to alleviate the sufferings of the population.

Thursday, December 7

Yair Golan, a former general, who was at some point deputy chief of staff, is entering politics and wants to revive the Israeli left, which certainly needs a new life. To my mind, he has the right ideas, but Israeli politics have seen many bright and courageous beginners. Let us wish him good luck!